

SilverTech Directory — Tour Guide

20 Questions to Ask on Your Independent Living Tour

Independent living is about lifestyle — not just a place to live. These questions help you find a community that truly fits.

Community & Culture

1. **What is the average age of residents**, and what is the general lifestyle tempo?
2. **Can I attend a community event or have lunch in the dining room before deciding?**
3. **What does a typical week of social programming look like?** Ask for the monthly calendar.
4. **Are there resident-led clubs, committees, or governance?**
5. **What is the pet policy?** Size limits, deposit, walking areas?

Services & Fees

6. **What is included in the monthly fee?** (Meals, housekeeping, utilities, activities, transportation)
7. **What services are available for an additional fee?** (Personal care, additional meals, extra housekeeping)
8. **How and how often can monthly fees increase?** What is the average annual increase?
9. **Is there an entrance fee or deposit, and is it refundable?**
10. **Are there different floor plan sizes and price points?**

Health & Continuum of Care

11. **What happens if a resident's health declines?** Is there assisted living or memory care on the same campus?

12. **Are any health or wellness services offered on-site** — fitness classes, visiting physicians, therapy?
13. **What is your protocol if a resident has a medical emergency?**
14. **Can home health aides come into the community** if a resident needs added support?

Practical Details

15. **What is the transportation program?** Scheduled routes, on-demand, medical appointments?
16. **What are the visitor and guest policies?** Can family stay overnight?
17. **How is maintenance and repair handled,** and what is the typical response time?
18. **What is the minimum age requirement?**

Financials & Long-Term Security

19. **What is the community's occupancy rate,** and how long have they been in operation?
20. **Who owns this community?** Is it part of a larger portfolio, and what is their financial standing?

Visit on a weekday and a weekend — the energy of a community varies. Talk to residents independently, without staff present.

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